KARUNGA JUNIOR SCHOOL
GRADE 9 ENGLISH
END OF TERM 1 EXAMINATION

Teacher-prepared assessment resource | Kenya CBC

Learner's Name:	_____	Grade:	9
Date:	_____	Time:	2 hours 30 minutes

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Answer all questions in Sections A, B and C.

2. Read the passage carefully before answering the comprehension questions.

3. Use correct grammar, spelling and punctuation.

4. Write the composition in clear, well-organised paragraphs.

5. The examination carries 100 marks.

SECTION A: READING COMPREHENSION (25 MARKS)

Read the passage below and answer the questions that follow.

THE SCHOOL GARDEN PROJECT

When Grade 9 learners at Mwangaza Junior School noticed that an unused corner of their compound was covered with litter, they proposed turning it into a learning garden. Their teacher encouraged them to develop a plan rather than begin work immediately. The learners formed groups, inspected the site and listed the materials they would need. They also discussed how the garden could support learning in science, agriculture and language.

Before planting, the learners cleared the area safely, sorted the waste and collected suitable materials for reuse. They prepared the soil, made planting beds and planted vegetables and indigenous tree seedlings. A simple watering timetable was created so that the plants would receive enough water without wasting it. Each group kept a record of growth, rainfall, pests and the work completed.

At first, the project faced difficulties. Some seedlings dried up during a hot week, while a few plants were damaged by animals. Instead of abandoning the work, the learners discussed possible solutions. They used mulch to conserve moisture, repaired a simple fence and asked the school community for advice. The garden gradually improved.

The project taught the learners that meaningful change requires planning, cooperation and patience. They also discovered that reading instructions, writing observations and presenting findings were important parts of practical work. By the end of the term, the garden provided vegetables for demonstrations and a green space that the whole school could enjoy.

1. Why did the Grade 9 learners propose creating a garden? (2 marks)

2. State two actions the learners took before planting. (2 marks)

3. Give two subjects or learning areas that the garden was intended to support. (2 marks)

4. Identify two challenges faced by the learners. (2 marks)

5. Explain how the learners responded to the problem of seedlings drying up. (2 marks)

6. What does the word “abandoning” mean as used in the passage? (1 mark)

7. Give one reason why the learners kept records of the garden's progress. (2 marks)

8. Explain two lessons the learners gained from the project. (4 marks)

9. In your own words, explain why cooperation was important to the success of the project. (3 marks)

10. Suggest two other ways the school could make the garden useful for learning. (5 marks)

SECTION B: LANGUAGE USE (25 MARKS)

11. Rewrite the following sentence in the passive voice: “The learners planted indigenous trees.” (2 marks)

12. Use the correct form of the word in brackets: The teacher gave a clear _____ (instruct) before the activity. (1 mark)

13. Choose the correct word: Neither the teacher nor the learners _____ absent yesterday. (was / were) (1 mark)

14. Join the sentences using “although”: The task was difficult. The learners completed it. (2 marks)

15. Punctuate correctly: mary asked can we visit the library tomorrow (3 marks)

16. Identify the adverb in this sentence: The learners carefully watered the seedlings. (1 mark)

17. Write the comparative and superlative forms of “good”. (2 marks)

18. Complete using the correct preposition: The learners were responsible _____ caring for the garden. (1 mark)

19. Change into reported speech: The teacher said, “We shall inspect the garden tomorrow.” (3 marks)

20. Write one synonym for each of the following words: (a) meaningful; (b) improve; (c) suitable. (3 marks)

21. Write one antonym for each of the following: (a) patience; (b) safe; (c) success. (3 marks)

22. Make a correct sentence using the word “cooperation”. (2 marks)

23. Identify the subject and predicate in this sentence: “The garden provided vegetables for demonstrations.” (1 mark)

SECTION C: WRITING (50 MARKS)

24. Write a composition of 250–350 words on ONE of the following topics:
(a) Describe a time when working with others helped you solve a problem.
OR
(b) Write a story ending with the words: “From that day, we understood the value of patience and teamwork.”
(50 marks)

MARKING SCHEME
GRADE 9 ENGLISH END OF TERM 1

TOTAL: 100 MARKS

SECTION A: READING COMPREHENSION (25 MARKS)

1. Because an unused corner of the school compound was covered with litter and they wanted to turn it into a learning garden. (2)

2. Any two: formed groups; inspected the site; listed materials; cleared/sorted waste safely; prepared soil or planting beds. (2)

3. Any two: science, agriculture and language. (2)

4. Seedlings dried up during a hot week; some plants were damaged by animals. (2)

5. They used mulch to conserve moisture. (2)

6. Giving up or leaving the project. (1)

7. To monitor growth, rainfall, pests and completed work; to evaluate progress or share findings. (2)

8. Any two explained: planning is important; cooperation helps solve problems; patience is needed; practical work involves reading, writing and presenting; environmental care benefits the school. (4)

9. Cooperation allowed learners to share tasks, ideas, resources and solutions, making the work manageable and helping them respond to challenges. (3)

10. Any relevant suggestions explained, e.g. measure plant growth for mathematics; observe insects for science; write reports; calculate harvests; prepare posters or presentations; use produce in nutrition lessons. Award up to 5 for relevant, explained ideas.

SECTION B: LANGUAGE USE (25 MARKS)

11. Indigenous trees were planted by the learners. (2)

12. instruction (1)

13. were (1)

14. Although the task was difficult, the learners completed it. (2)

15. Mary asked, “Can we visit the library tomorrow?” (3)

16. carefully (1)

17. Comparative: better; superlative: best. (2)

18. for (1)

19. The teacher said that they would inspect the garden the following day. (3)

20. (a) significant/important; (b) enhance/develop; (c) appropriate/appropriate for the purpose. Accept suitable synonyms. (3)

21. (a) impatience; (b) dangerous/unsafe; (c) failure. (3)

22. Any grammatically correct sentence that uses “cooperation” appropriately. (2)

23. Subject: The garden; predicate: provided vegetables for demonstrations. (1)

SECTION C: WRITING (50 MARKS)

Use the following rubric for either composition topic:

Criterion	Marks	Guidance
Content and relevance	10 marks	Addresses the topic clearly; ideas are relevant and sufficiently developed.
Organisation and coherence	10 marks	Clear beginning, logical sequence, paragraphing and effective conclusion.
Language and expression	15 marks	Appropriate vocabulary, sentence variety, grammar and clarity.
Mechanics	10 marks	Spelling, punctuation, capitalisation and paragraph presentation.
Creativity and impact	5 marks	Engaging details, originality and effective communication.

GENERAL MARKING GUIDANCE

Accept alternative answers that are accurate and supported by the passage or by accepted English usage.

For comprehension, award marks for meaning rather than exact reproduction of the marking-guide wording.

For composition, use the rubric consistently and annotate strengths and areas for improvement.

Teachers should confirm that the assessed language skills and text types have been taught. This is an original teacher-prepared paper, not an official KICD examination.

END OF EXAMINATION